



Develop and implement operational plans

D2.TTO.CL4.06

Assessor Manual



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Competency Based Assessment (CBA) – An Introduction for Assessors

Assessment is the process of identifying a participant's current knowledge, skills and attitudes sets against all elements of competency within a unit of competency.

Suggested Assessment Methods

For each unit of competency a number of assessment tools have been identified including:

- Work Projects
- Oral Questions
- Written Questions
- Third Party Statements
- Observation Checklists.

Instructions and Evidence Recording Sheets have been identified in this Assessment Manual for use by Assessors.

Alternative Assessment Methods

Whilst the above mentioned assessment methods are suggested assessment methods, the assessor may use an alternate method of assessment taking into account:

- a) The nature of the unit
- b) The strengths of participants
- c) The number of participants in the class
- d) Time required to complete assessments
- e) Time dedicated to assessment
- f) Equipment and resources required.

Alternate assessment methods include:

- Practical demonstrations
- Practical demonstrations in simulated work conditions
- Problem solving
- Portfolios of evidence
- Critical incident reports
- Journals
- Oral presentations
- Interviews
- Videos
- Visuals/slides/audiotapes

- Case studies
- Log books
- Projects and Role plays
- Group projects
- Recognition of Prior Learning.

Whilst there is no specific instruction or evidence collection documents for all the alternative assessment methods, assessors can record competency in the 'Other' section within the 'Competency Recording Sheet'.

Selection of Assessment Methods

Each assessor will determine the combination of Assessment Methods to be used to determine Competency for each Competency Unit on a student by student basis.

'Sufficient' evidence to support the 'Pass Competent'/'Not Yet Competent' decision must be captured.

In practice this means a minimum of 2 – 3 Assessment Methods for each candidate for each Competency Element is suggested.

At least one method should provide evidence of practical demonstration of competence.

The following assessment methods deemed to provide evidence of practical demonstration of competence include:

- Practical Work Projects
- Third Party Statement
- Observation Checklist.

Assessing Competency

Competency based assessment does not award grades, but simply identifies if the participant has the knowledge, skills and attitudes to undertake the required task to the specified standard.

Therefore, when assessing competency, an assessor has two possible results that can be awarded:

- 'Pass Competent' (PC)
- 'Not Yet Competent' (NYC).

Pass Competent (PC)

If the participant is able to successfully answer or demonstrate what is required, to the expected standards of the performance criteria, they will be deemed as 'Pass Competent' (PC).

The assessor will award a 'Pass Competent' (PC) if they feel the participant has the necessary knowledge, skills and attitudes in all assessment tasks for a unit.

Not Yet Competent' (NYC)

If the participant is unable to answer or demonstrate competency to the desired standard, they will be deemed to be 'Not Yet Competent' (NYC).

This does not mean the participant will need to complete all the assessment tasks again. The focus will be on the specific assessment tasks that were not performed to the expected standards.

The participant may be required to:

- a) Undertake further training or instruction
- b) Undertake the assessment task again until they are deemed to be 'Pass Competent'.

Regional Qualifications Framework and Skills Recognition System

The 'Regional Qualifications Framework and Skills Recognition System', also known as the 'RQFSRS' is the overriding educational framework for the ASEAN region.

The purpose of this framework is to provide:

- A standardised teaching and assessment framework
- Mutual recognition of participant achievement across the ASEAN region. This includes achievement in individual Units of Competency or qualifications as a whole.

The role of the 'RQFSRS' is to provide, ensure and maintain 'quality assurance' across all countries and educational providers across the ASEAN region

Recognition of Prior Learning (RPL)

Recognition of Prior Learning is the process that gives current industry professionals who do not have a formal qualification, the opportunity to benchmark their extensive skills and experience against the standards set out in each unit of competency/subject.

This process is a learning and assessment pathway which encompasses:

- Recognition of Current Competencies (RCC)
- Skills auditing
- Gap analysis and training
- Credit transfer.

Code of Practice for Assessors

This Code of Practice provides:

- Assessors with direction on the standard of practice expected of them
- Candidates with assurance of the standards of practice expected of assessors
- Employers with assurance of the standards maintained in the conduct of assessment.

The Code detailed below is based on the International Code of Ethics and Practice (The National Council for Measurement in Education [NCME]):

- The differing needs and requirements of the person being assessed, the local enterprise and/or industry are identified and handled with sensitivity
- Potential forms of conflict of interest in the assessment process and/or outcomes are identified and appropriate referrals are made, if necessary
- All forms of harassment are avoided throughout the planning, conducting, reviewing and reporting of the assessment outcomes

- The rights of the candidate are protected during and after the assessment
- Personal and interpersonal factors that are not relevant to the assessment of competency must not influence the assessment outcomes
- The candidate is made aware of rights and process of appeal
- Evidence that is gathered during the assessment is verified for validity, reliability, authenticity, sufficiency and currency
- Assessment decisions are based on available evidence that can be produced and verified by another assessor
- Assessments are conducted within the boundaries of the assessment system policies and procedures
- Formal agreement is obtained from both the candidate and the assessor that the assessment was carried out in accordance with agreed procedures
- The candidate is informed of all assessment reporting processes prior to the assessment
- The candidate is informed of all known potential consequences of decisions arising from an assessment, prior to the assessment
- Confidentiality is maintained regarding assessment results
- The assessment results are used consistently with the purposes explained to the candidate
- Opportunities are created for technical assistance in planning, conducting and reviewing assessment procedures and outcomes.

Instructions and Checklist for Assessors

Instructions

General instructions for the assessment:

- Assessment should be conducted at a scheduled time that has been notified to the candidate
- Facilitators must ensure participants are made aware of the need to complete assessments and attend assessment sessions
- If a participant is unable to attend a scheduled session, they must make arrangements with the Assessor to undertake the assessment at an alternative time
- At the end of the assessment the Assessor must give feedback and advise the participant on their PC/NYC status
- Complete the relevant documentation and submit to the appropriate department.

Preparation

- Gain familiarity with the Unit of Competency, Elements of Competency and the Performance Criteria expected
- Study details assessment documentation and requirements
- Brief candidate regarding all assessment criteria and requirements.

Briefing Checklist

- Begin the assessment by implementing the following checklist and then invite the candidate to proceed with assessment.

Checklist for Assessors

Prior to the assessment I have:	Tick (✓)	Remarks
Ensured the candidate is informed about the venue and schedule of assessment.		
Received current copies of the performance criteria to be assessed, assessment plan, evidence gathering plan, assessment checklist, appeal form and the company's standard operating procedures (SOP).		
Reviewed the performance criteria and evidence plan to ensure I clearly understood the instructions and the requirements of the assessment process.		
Identified and accommodated any special needs of the candidate.		
Checked the set-up and resources for the assessment.		
During the assessment I have:		
Introduced myself and confirmed identities of candidates.		
Put candidates at ease by being friendly and helpful.		
Explained to candidates the purpose, context and benefits of the assessment.		
Ensured candidates understood the assessment process and all attendant procedures.		
Provided candidates with an overview of performance criteria to be assessed.		
Explained the results reporting procedure.		
Encouraged candidates to seek clarifications if in doubt.		
Asked candidates for feedback on the assessment.		
Explained legal, safety and ethical issues, if applicable.		
After the assessment I have:		
Ensured candidate is given constructive feedback.		
Completed and signed the assessment record.		
Thanked candidate for participating in the assessment.		

Instructions for Recording Competency

Specifications for Recording Competency

The following specifications apply to the preparation of Evidence Gathering Plans:

- A Competency Recording Sheet must be prepared for each candidate to ensure and demonstrate all Performance Criteria and Competency Elements are appropriately assessed. This Sheet indicates how the Assessor will gather evidence during their assessment of each candidate
- This Competency Recording Sheet is located at the end of the Assessment Plan
- It is the overriding document to record competency
- The Assessor may vary the Competency Recording Sheet to accommodate practical and individual candidate and/or workplace needs
- Assessor must place a tick (✓) in the 'Assessment Method' columns to identify the methods of assessment to be used for each candidate
- Multiple Competency Elements/Performance Criteria may be assessed at the one time, where appropriate
- The assessor and participant should sign and date the Competency Recording Sheet, when all forms of evidence and assessment have been completed
- The assessor may provide and feedback or clarify questions which the participant may have in regards to the assessment grade or findings
- All documents used to capture evidence must be retained, and attached to the Competency Recording Sheet for each candidate for each Competency Unit.

Instructions for Different Assessment Methods

Specifications for Work Project Assessment

These guidelines concern the use of work projects.

The work projects identified in the Training Manuals involve a range of tasks, to be performed at the discretion of the Assessor.

Work project tasks can be completed through any form of assessment as identified in the Trainer and Trainee Manuals and stated at the start of this section.

Assessors should follow these guidelines:

- Review the Work Projects at the end of each 'Element of Competency' in the Trainee Manual to ensure you understand the content and what is expected
- Prepare sufficient resources for the completion of work activities including:
 - Time – whether in scheduled delivery hours or suggested time participants to spend outside of class hours
 - Resources – this may involve technical equipment, computer, internet access, stationery and other supplementary materials and documents
- Prepare assessment location (if done in class) making it conducive to assessment
- Explain Work Projects assessment to candidate, at the start of each Element of Competency. This ensures that participants are aware of what is expected and can collate information as delivery takes place

- Assessors can use the following phrase as a guide (where an 'X' is identified, please input appropriate information):
 "At the end of each Element of Competency there are Work Projects which must be completed. These projects require different tasks that must be completed.
 These work projects are part of the formal assessment for the unit of competency titled X:
- You are required to complete these activities:
 - Using the 'X' method of assessment*
 - At 'X' location*
 - You will have 'X time period' for this assessment*
 - You are required to compile information in a format that you feel is appropriate to the assessment
 - Do you have any questions about this assessment?"
- Commence Work Project assessment:
 - The assessor may give time for participants to review the questions at this time to ensure they understand the nature of the questions. The assessor may need to clarify questions
 - Participants complete work projects in the most appropriate format
 - Participants must submit Work Project evidence to the assessor before the scheduled due date
- Assessor must assess the participant's evidence against the competency standards specified in each Element of Competency and their own understanding. The assessor can determine if the participant has provided evidence to a 'competent' standard
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet
- Forward/file assessment record.

Specifications for Oral Question Assessment

These guidelines concern the use of oral questioning.

Assessors should follow these guidelines.

- Prepare Assessment Record for Oral Questioning. One record for each candidate:
 - Enter Student name
 - Enter Assessor name
 - Enter Location
- Familiarise self with Questions to be asked
- Prepare assessment location (table and chairs) making it conducive to assessment
- Explain Oral Questioning assessment to candidate, using the following phrase as a guide (where a 'X' is identified, please input appropriate information):
"These oral questions are part of the formal assessment for the unit of competency titled X.

There are X questions and you are required to answer all of them to the best of your ability and I will record whether or not you have answered correctly.

We have 60 minutes for this assessment.

- I will give you feedback at the end of the assessment
- Do you have any questions about this assessment?”
- Commence Oral Questioning assessment:
 - Complete Assessment Record for the Oral Questioning by:
 - a) Ticking PC or NYC, as appropriate
 - b) Entering ‘Remarks’ as required
 - c) Completing Oral Questioning within 60 minutes
- Complete Oral Questioning and provide feedback to candidate
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet
- Forward/file assessment record.

Specifications for Written Question Assessment

These guidelines concern the use of written questioning.

Assessors should follow these guidelines:

- Familiarise self with Questions and Answers provided
- Print and distribute copies of ‘Written Questions’ for participants. Ideally this should take place with adequate time for participants to answer all questions before the expected due date
- Explain Written Questioning assessment to candidate, using the following phrase as a guide (where a ‘X’ is identified, please input appropriate information):

“These written questions are part of the formal assessment for the unit of competency titled X.

There are X questions and you are required to answer all of them to the best of your ability.

You may refer to your subject materials, however where possible try to utilise your existing knowledge when answering questions.

Where you are unsure of questions, please ask the Assessor for further instruction. This may be answering the question orally or asking the assessor to redefine the question.

We have X time for this assessment:

- The due date for completion of this assessment is X
- On this date you must forward the completed questions to the assessor by X time on the date of X
- Do you have any questions about this assessment?”
- The assessor may give time for participants to review the questions at this time to ensure they understand the nature of the questions. The assessor may need to clarify questions
- Participants may record written answers (where possible)
- Participants must submit the written answers to the assessor before the scheduled due date

- Assessor must assess the participant's written answers against the model answers provided as a guide, or their own understanding. The assessor can determine if the participant has answered the questions to a 'competent' standard
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet
- Forward/file assessment record.

Specifications for Observation Checklist

These specifications apply to the use of the Observation Checklist in determining competency for candidates.

Only an approved assessor is authorised to complete the Observation Checklist.

The assessor is required to observe the participant, ideally in a simulated environment or their practical workplace setting and record their performance (or otherwise) of the competencies listed on the Observation Checklist for the Competency Unit.

To complete the Observation Checklist the Assessor must:

- Insert name of candidate
- Insert assessor name
- Insert identify of location where observations are being undertaken
- Insert date/s of observations – may be single date or multiple dates
- Place a tick in either the 'Yes' or 'No' box for each listed Performance Criteria to indicate the candidate has demonstrated/not demonstrated that skill
- Provide written (and verbal) feedback to candidate – as/if appropriate
- Sign and date the form
- Present form to candidate for them to sign and date
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet for candidate
- Forward/file Observation Checklist.

This source of evidence combines with other forms of assessment to assist in determining the 'Pass Competent' or 'Not Yet Competent' decision for the participant.

Specifications for Third Party Statement

These specifications relate to the use of a relevant workplace person to assist in determining competency for candidates.

The Third Party Statement is to be supplied by the assessor to a person in the workplace who supervises and/or works closely with the participant.

This may be their Supervisor, the venue manager, the Department Manager or similar.

The Third Party Statement asks the Supervisor to record what they believe to be the competencies of the participant based on their workplace experience of the participant. This experience may be gained through observation of their workplace performance, feedback from others, inspection of candidate's work etc.

A meeting must take place between the Assessor and the Third Party to explain and demonstrate the use of the Third Party Statement.

To complete the Third Party Verification Statement the Assessor must:

- Insert candidate name
- Insert name and contact details of the Third Party
- Tick the box to indicate the relationship of the Third Party to the candidate
- Present the partially completed form to the Third Party for them to finalise
- Collect the completed form from the Third Party
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet for candidate
- Forward/file Third Party Statement.

The Third Party must:

- Record their belief regarding candidate ability/competency as either:
 - Pass Competent = Yes
 - Not Yet Competent = No
 - Unsure about whether candidate is competent or not = Not Sure
- Meet briefly with the assessor to discuss and/or clarify the form.

This source of evidence combines with other forms of assessment to assist in determining the 'Pass Competent' or 'Not Yet Competent' decision for the candidate.

A separate Third Party Statement is required for each Competency Unit undertaken by the candidate.

Competency standard

UNIT TITLE: DEVELOP AND IMPLEMENT OPERATIONAL PLANS		NOMINAL HOURS: 60
UNIT NUMBER: D2.TTO.CL4.06		
UNIT DESCRIPTOR: This unit deals with the skills and knowledge required to develop and implement operational plans in a range of settings within the travel industries.		
ELEMENTS AND PERFORMANCE CRITERIA		UNIT VARIABLE AND ASSESSMENT GUIDE
Element 1. Develop operational plans 1.1 Develop <i>operational plans</i> and <i>strategies</i> based on monitoring of workplace needs and identification of opportunities for improvement and innovation 1.2 Develop scope and <i>objectives</i> of the required initiative based on enterprise goals, staff and customer feedback 1.3 Identify and <i>analyse internal and external factors</i> that may impact on the plan 1.4 Consult appropriate <i>stakeholders</i> during the development of the plan 1.5 Develop appropriate and financially-sound resource strategies 1.6 Develop administrative framework and systems capable of supporting the planned initiative		Unit Variables The Unit Variables provide advice to interpret the scope and context of this unit of competence, allowing for differences between enterprises and workplaces. It relates to the unit as a whole and facilitates holistic assessment. This unit applies to developing and implementing operational plans within the labour divisions of the hotel and travel industries and may include: 1. Tour Operation The <i>operational plan</i> may be for • Introduction of a new product • Staff re-organisation • Impacts of marketing initiatives or campaigns • An office relocation or refurbishment • Upgrading of facilities • Changes in work practices or procedures • Business expansion or contraction • Introduction of new systems.

1.7 Identify and communicate clearly all priorities, responsibilities and timelines 1.8 Develop evaluation systems in consultation with appropriate colleagues Element 2. Administer and monitor operational plans 2.1 Implement and <i>evaluate</i> identified actions in accordance with agreed priorities 2.2 Monitor <i>performance indicators</i> 2.3 Provide progress and other reports in accordance with enterprise requirements 2.4 Make assessment of the need for additional resource requirements and take appropriate action in accordance with enterprise policy Element 3. Conduct ongoing evaluation 3.1 <i>Review the operational plan</i> to assess effectiveness in the workplace 3.2 Monitor <i>performance</i> 3.3 Identify problems and make adjustments accordingly 3.4 Incorporate the results of evaluation into ongoing planning and operational management	<i>Strategies</i> may include: • Client development • Geographic expansion • Organisational growth • Service growth • Debt reduction • Income development. <i>Objectives</i> may include: • Sales figures • Revenues • Delivery times • Service standards • Client numbers • Sales figures and targets • Booking levels • Customer or staff feedback • Productivity gains. <i>Analyse internal and external factors</i> may relate to: • Capabilities and resources: • Human resources • Financial resources • Equipment capacity • Staff skill levels
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- | | |
|--|--|
| | <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Hours of operation• Communication capabilities• Location/position• Trends and developments in the marketplace:<ul style="list-style-type: none">▪ Economic▪ Ecological/environmental▪ Government activities▪ Social and cultural▪ Demographic▪ Technology▪ Industrial• Comparative market information:<ul style="list-style-type: none">▪ Best practice information▪ Benchmarking▪ Competitor information• Legal and ethical constraints:<ul style="list-style-type: none">▪ Legislation▪ Regulation▪ Codes of practice▪ Cultural expectations and influences• Social responsibilities, e.g. Protection of children and environmental issues. |
|--|--|

	<i>Stakeholders</i> may include: • Customers • Employees • Government agencies • Owners • Suppliers • Strategic alliance partners. <i>Evaluate</i> may include • Key performance indicators • Gap analysis • Customer feedback • Compliance reports • Employee feedback. <i>Performance indicators</i> may include: • Sales • Return on investment • Customer service • Debt servicing costs. <i>Review the operational plan</i> may relate to: • Quarterly reviews • Business plan cycle • Major events triggering a review, e.g. Change in market place.
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	<i>Performance</i> may relate to: • Market share • Sales figures • Customer satisfaction. Assessment Guide The following skills and knowledge must be assessed as part of this unit: • Knowledge of the key planning concepts and techniques including the structure of plans and steps in the planning process • Understanding of current internal and external environments which impact on planning within the enterprise or industry sector • Knowledge of research skills sufficient to source and analyse a broad range of information on varying issues and from multiple sources • Knowledge of legal issues that impact on enterprise operations as appropriate to the industry sector. Linkages To Other Units • Develop and implement business plans • Plan and establish systems and procedures • Prepare business documents • Maintain financial standards and records • Manage legal requirements for business compliance • Manage physical assets and infrastructure • Lead and manage people.
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	Critical Aspects of Assessment Evidence of the following is essential: • Demonstrated ability to undertake detailed, thorough and appropriate analysis of both internal and external business environments to provide a sound basis for business planning • Demonstrated ability to develop and implement an integrated operational plan within a travel and hotel industry context • Consistency of performance across a range of situations that demonstrates knowledge, understanding and skill in implementing the principles and practices of developing and implementing operational plans • Demonstrated ability to collect and analyse financial performance information • Demonstrated ability to plan and forecast • Demonstrated ability to schedule activities to meet milestones • Demonstrated ability to research data and trends. Context of Assessment This unit may be assessed on or off the job: • Assessment should include practical demonstration of the ability to develop and implement an operational plan in the workplace or through a simulation activity, supported by a range of methods to assess underpinning knowledge • Assessment must relate to the individual's work area, job role and area of responsibility • Assessment must include project or work activities that allow the candidate to respond to multiple and varying workplace issues relevant to work area, job role and area of responsibility that allow the candidate to demonstrate knowledge and awareness of developing and implementing operational plans.
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	Resource Implications		
	Training and assessment to include access to a real or simulated commercial workplace environment in which the operational plan can be implemented; and access to workplace standards, procedures, policies, guidelines, tools and equipment.		
	Assessment Methods		
	The following methods may be used to assess competency for this unit:		
	• Case studies • Observation of practical candidate performance • Oral and written questions • Portfolio evidence • Problem solving • Role plays • Third party reports completed by a supervisor • Project and assignment work.		
	Key Competencies in this Unit		
	<i>Level 1 = competence to undertake tasks effectively</i>		
	<i>Level 2 = competence to manage tasks</i>		
	<i>Level 3 = competence to use concepts for evaluating</i>		
	Key Competencies	Level	Examples
	Collecting, organising and analysing information	3	Identify and analyse competitive activity
	Communicating ideas and information	3	Express complex strategies in a clear and concise format

	Planning and organising activities	3	Coordinate stakeholder involvement in the planning process
	Working with others and in teams	3	Devise strategies to ensure team commitment to business strategies
	Using mathematical ideas and techniques	2	Create financial projections and forecasts
	Solving problems	3	Adjust strategies to respond to severe and sudden budgetary constraints
	Using technology	2	Identify and analyse the optimum use of technology to achieve business objectives

Oral questions

Student name	
Assessor name	
Location/venue	
Unit of competency	Develop and implement operational plans D2.TTO.CL4.06
Instructions	1. Ask student questions from the attached list to confirm knowledge, as necessary 2. Place tick in boxes to reflect student achievement (Pass Competent 'PC' or Not Yet Competent 'NYC') 3. Write short-form student answer in the space provided for each question.

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
1. What are examples of the 'purpose' and 'strategies' of operational plans?	☐	☐
2. Why is it important to have 'measurable' goals and objectives?	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
3. What factors would you analyse in relation to the 'internal' environment?	☐	☐
4. What experts would you consult with when developing operational plans? Why would you consult with them?	☐	☐
5. What are common resources used in a tourism organisation?	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
6. What are the two categories of operational plans? Provide an example of each.	☐	☐
7. How can you communicate operational plans to stakeholders?	☐	☐
8. Why is it important to develop control and evaluation systems?	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
9. Describe the role of 'task' and 'maintenance' functions that are used when implementing operational plans.	☐	☐
10. Why is it important to monitor and review performance systems and processes?	☐	☐
11. What are examples of performance related information that should be communicated to stakeholders and managers?	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
12. Provide an example of when a manager should 'do nothing' when a problem has been identified.	☐	☐
13. Why is it important to review operational plans?	☐	☐
14. Why is it important to monitor operational activities?	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
15. What types of 'corrective action' can be taken when performance gaps are identified?	☐	☐
16. When presenting recommendations for variation to operational or operational plans what information needs to be included?	☐	☐

Written questions

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Student Name: _____

Answer all the following questions and submit to your Trainer.

1. What is an operational plan?

2. What are the benefits of operational planning?

3. What is the purpose of having objectives? What are some examples of objectives?

4. What does the term 'SMART' goal mean?

5. What factors would you analyse in relation to the 'external' environment?

6. Why is it important to involve stakeholders when developing operational plans?

7. What are the four categories resources that must be considered when developing operational plans?

8. What are inclusions in an operational plan?

9. What are staff considerations that must be met when communicating operational plans to them?

10. What are the three types of controls?

11. What are examples of considerations when implementing operational plan activities?

12. What are predictable consequences of change?

13. Why is it important to review key performance indicators?

14. How can you review Key Performance Indicators?

15. What are methods used to share performance related information?

16. What are the three types of managerial action that can be taken when 'operational problems / performance gaps' are identified?

17. What are questions that you are trying to answer when conducting on-going evaluation of operational plans?

18. What are areas of performance to monitor?

19. What are types of performance gaps that can be identified when monitoring operational performance?

20. What are reasons for presenting recommendations for variation to operational or operational plans?

Answers to written questions

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The following are model answers only – Trainers/Assessors must use discretion when determining whether or not an answer provided by a Student is acceptable or not.

1. What is an operational plan?

An operational plan is a written document that presents detailed information about:

- The business
- Its projected plans and projections for the future
- How the plans will be implemented.

2. What are the benefits of operational planning?

- Provides guidance towards objectives
- Reduces uncertainty, expense and duplication of effort
- Supplies a means to track and assess performance
- Helps to ensure that various activities are integrated
- Information allows us to adapt and adjust to changing environments
- Agreement is gained on major issues
- The whole operating picture is seen more clearly
- Responsibility is placed more precisely
- A sense of order and control over activities exists
- There is coordination between different work units/departments
- Objectives are more specific and better known throughout the organisation
- Guesswork is minimised
- Time, effort and money can be saved
- There is a reduction in decision making errors.

3. What is the purpose of having objectives? What are some examples of objectives?

The objectives are the goals or targets to work towards and once defined, enable the planning of strategies to achieve them.

Types of objectives:

- Sales figures
- Revenues
- Delivery times
- Service standards
- Client numbers
- Sales figures and targets
- Client handling times
- Staff turnover
- Profit margins
- Booking levels
- Customer or staff feedback
- Productivity gains.

4. What does the term 'SMART' goal mean?

- Specific
- Measurable
- Achievable
- Relevant and realistic
- Time-specific.

5. What factors would you analyse in relation to the 'external' environment?

- Analysis of external environment
- Competitors
- Economic climate
- Customer preferences
- E-operational
- Markets
- Environment
- Technology
- Political issues
- Legal issues
- Social issues and trends.

6. Why is it important to involve stakeholders when developing operational plans?

Ensures stakeholders:

- Are involved
- Had the chance to contribute ideas
- Provide feedback on initial concepts
- Understand how concepts will affect them
- How concepts interrelate or impact other stakeholders.

7. What are the four categories resources that must be considered when developing operational plans?

- Physical resources
- Human resources
- Financial resources
- Intellectual property.

8. What are inclusions in an operational plan?

- Overall goals / objectives
- What actions need to be done
- To what standard must it be done (Key Performance Indicators)
- What policies or procedures must be adhered to
- Who is responsible for action
- Timelines about when things are going to happen
- What tasks are associated with actions
- How the action is inter related and interdependent
- Specific details of how things are going to be done
- Actions will need to be prioritised and listed in order
- What standards or measures can be applied straight after the action is completed?
- Where the action will take place?
- What additional resources will be required?
- Timelines for actions
- Support mechanisms
- Develop a system of measuring recording and reporting results.

9. What are staff considerations that must be met when communicating operational plans to them?

- Get a clear understanding of the operational plan
- Ensure that all key concerns have been considered
- Understand the benefits of the operational plan
- Understand how the operational plan will benefit them
- Understand how the operational plan will impact on them
- Understand their role in implementing the operational plan
- Any potential problems identified
- Have their concerns addressed
- Be excited and reassured about the operational plan.

10. What are the three types of controls?

- Feed forward control
- Concurrent control
- Feedback control.

11. What are examples of considerations when implementing operational plan activities?

- Compliance requirements
- Occupational safety and health (OSH)
- Legal liability exposure
- Integration with other aspects of the operational
- Timing issues
- Resources
- Changes to policies and procedures
- Documentation and record keeping
- Service delivery
- Impact on organisational culture.

12. What are predictable consequences of change?

- Disruptions to routine
- Problems with timelines
- Issues with reporting structure
- Extra support required by employees.

13. Why is it important to review key performance indicators?

To ensure they are accurate, realistic and still relevant.

14. How can you review Key Performance Indicators?

- Discuss KPIs with key stakeholders
- Reviewing each KPI to ensure it is still accurate
- Reviewing 'required level of achievement' for each KPI
- Checking level of success against current KPI's
- Identifying reasons why KPI's have or have not being met
- Determine is KPI's need to be amended
- Making recommendations for changes where amendments are required.

15. What are methods used to share performance related information?

- Holding team meetings
- Providing hard copy information
- Sharing information via the intranet
- Disseminating information at staff briefings.

16. What are the three types of managerial action that can be taken when 'operational problems / performance gaps' are identified?

- Do nothing
- Correct actual performance
- Revise the standard.

17. What are questions that you are trying to answer when conducting on-going evaluation of operational plans?

- Are we on track?
- Have we achieved what we planned?
- Are any variations acceptable, or do they require action?
- Were the original goals realistic and achievable?
- Have we improved our planning ability through these actions?

18. What are areas of performance to monitor?

- Market share
- Sales figures
- Customer satisfaction
- Staff satisfaction
- Growth in existing markets
- Development of new business sectors
- Staff retention
- Awards received.

19. What are types of performance gaps that can be identified when monitoring operational performance?

- Product or service failures
- Long wait times for service
- High volume of customer traffic
- Inaccurate or conflicting information provided to customers
- Lack of follow-up action by customer care representatives
- Aggressive cross-selling or up-selling by customer service representatives or sales persons
- Lack of resources required to implement service operations
- Conflicts in priorities
- Resource constraints
- Lack of information
- Supplier delays
- Differences in opinion
- Interpersonal conflict
- Hazardous events
- Time constraints
- Electricity shortages
- Bad weather
- Shortfalls in expected outcomes
- Poor staff performance.

20. What are reasons for presenting recommendations for variation to operational or operational plans?

These recommendations will usually be on the basis of:

- Unsatisfactory performance
 - A business opportunity
 - Customer feedback
 - Significant alteration to the premises or operational systems.
-

Observation checklist

Student name	
Assessor name	
Location/venue	
Unit of competency	Develop and implement operational plans D2.TTO.CL4.06
Dates of observation	
Instructions	- Over a period of time observe the student completing each of the following tasks: - Develop operational plans - Administer and monitor operational plans - Conduct ongoing evaluation - Enter the date on which the tasks were undertaken - Place a tick in the box to show they completed each aspect of the task to the standard expected in the enterprise - Complete the feedback sections of the form, if required.

Did the candidate	Yes	No
Element 1: Develop operational plans		
Develop operational plans and strategies based on monitoring of workplace needs and identification of opportunities for improvement and innovation	☐	☐
Develop scope and objectives of the required initiative based on enterprise goals, staff and customer feedback	☐	☐
Identify and analyse internal and external factors that may impact on the plan	☐	☐
Consult appropriate stakeholders during the development of the plan	☐	☐
Develop appropriate and financially-sound resource strategies	☐	☐
Develop administrative framework and systems capable of supporting the planned initiative	☐	☐
Identify and communicate clearly all priorities, responsibilities and timelines	☐	☐
Develop evaluation systems in consultation with appropriate colleagues	☐	☐

Did the candidate	Yes	No
Element 2: Administer and monitor operational plans		
Implement and evaluate identified actions in accordance with agreed priorities	☐	☐
Monitor performance indicators	☐	☐
Provide progress and other reports in accordance with enterprise requirements	☐	☐
Make assessment of the need for additional resource requirements and take appropriate action in accordance with enterprise policy	☐	☐
Element 3: Conduct ongoing evaluation		
Review the operational plan to assess effectiveness in the workplace	☐	☐
Monitor performance	☐	☐
Identify problems and make adjustments accordingly	☐	☐
Incorporate the results of evaluation into ongoing planning and operational management	☐	☐
Did the student's overall performance meet the standard?	☐	☐

Feedback to student and trainer/assessor**Strengths:****Improvements needed:****General comments:****Candidate signature****Date****Assessor signature****Date**

Third Party Statement

Student name:			
Name of third party:		Contact no:	
Relationship to student:	☐ Employer ☐ Supervisor ☐ Colleague ☐ Other Please specify: _____ Please do not complete the form if you are a relative, close friend or have a conflict of interest		
Unit of competency:	Develop and implement operational plans D2.TTO.CL4.06		
The student is being assessed against industry competency standards and we are seeking your support in the judgement of their competence. Please answer these questions as a record of their performance while working with you. Thank you for your time.			
Do you believe the trainee has demonstrated the following skills? <i>(tick the correct response)</i>	Yes	No	Not sure
Element 1: Develop operational plans			
Develop operational plans and strategies based on monitoring of workplace needs and identification of opportunities for improvement and innovation	☐	☐	☐
Develop scope and objectives of the required initiative based on enterprise goals, staff and customer feedback	☐	☐	☐
Identify and analyse internal and external factors that may impact on the plan	☐	☐	☐
Consult appropriate stakeholders during the development of the plan	☐	☐	☐
Develop appropriate and financially-sound resource strategies	☐	☐	☐
Develop administrative framework and systems capable of supporting the planned initiative	☐	☐	☐
Identify and communicate clearly all priorities, responsibilities and timelines	☐	☐	☐
Develop evaluation systems in consultation with appropriate colleagues	☐	☐	☐

Do you believe the trainee has demonstrated the following skills? <i>(tick the correct response)</i>	Yes	No	Not sure
Element 2: Administer and monitor operational plans			
Implement and evaluate identified actions in accordance with agreed priorities	☐	☐	☐
Monitor performance indicators	☐	☐	☐
Provide progress and other reports in accordance with enterprise requirements	☐	☐	☐
Make assessment of the need for additional resource requirements and take appropriate action in accordance with enterprise policy	☐	☐	☐
Element 3: Conduct ongoing evaluation			
Review the operational plan to assess effectiveness in the workplace	☐	☐	☐
Monitor performance	☐	☐	☐
Identify problems and make adjustments accordingly	☐	☐	☐
Incorporate the results of evaluation into ongoing planning and operational management	☐	☐	☐

Comments/feedback from Third Party to Trainer/Assessor:**Third party signature:****Date:****Send to:**

Competency recording sheet

Name of Student		
Name of Assessor/s		
Unit of Competency	Develop and implement operational plans	D2.TTO.CL4.06
Date assessment commenced		
Date assessment finalised		
Assessment decision	Pass Competent / Not Yet Competent (Circle one)	
Follow up action required (Insert additional work and assessment required to achieve competency)		
Comments/observations by assessor/s		

Place a tick (✓) in the column to reflect evidence obtained to determine Competency of the student for each Performance Criteria.

Element and Performance Criteria	Observation of skills	3rd Party Statement	Oral Questions	Written Questions	Work Projects	Other
Element 1: Develop operational plans						
Develop operational plans and strategies based on monitoring of workplace needs and identification of opportunities for improvement and innovation						
Develop scope and objectives of the required initiative based on enterprise goals, staff and customer feedback						
Identify and analyse internal and external factors that may impact on the plan						
Consult appropriate stakeholders during the development of the plan						
Develop appropriate and financially-sound resource strategies						
Develop administrative framework and systems capable of supporting the planned initiative						
Identify and communicate clearly all priorities, responsibilities and timelines						
Develop evaluation systems in consultation with appropriate colleagues						

Place a tick (✓) in the column to reflect evidence obtained to determine Competency of the student for each Performance Criteria.

Element and Performance Criteria	Observation of skills	3rd Party Statement	Oral Questions	Written Questions	Work Projects	Other
Element 2: Administer and monitor operational plans						
Implement and evaluate identified actions in accordance with agreed priorities						
Monitor performance indicators						
Provide progress and other reports in accordance with enterprise requirements						
Make assessment of the need for additional resource requirements and take appropriate action in accordance with enterprise policy						
Element 3: Conduct ongoing evaluation						
Review the operational policy to assess effectiveness in the workplace						
Monitor performance						
Identify problems and make adjustments accordingly						
Incorporate the results of evaluation into ongoing planning and operational management						
Candidate signature:		Date:				
Assessor signature:		Date:				

